

FREE SPRINT PLAN

The 14-Day Remote Job Search Sprint

Applying to 100 jobs a month is not a strategy. This two-week plan is.

WHAT IS INSIDE

- A day-by-day plan: 3 focused hours a day, 14 days
- The follow-up cadence that actually gets replies
- A pipeline tracker that stops applications dying in your inbox

A remote posting is not a local posting with the commute removed. The applicant pool is worldwide, so an untailored application is the median application. And a large share of listings labeled remote are restricted to one country or region. In my experience, more than half of the applications in a 100-a-month habit go to roles the applicant was never eligible for, with a resume that was never tailored, to a company where nobody knows their name.

This sprint replaces that with 14 days of 3 focused hours: three days of setup, seven days of targeted applications with a human contact and a follow-up date attached to each, and four days of interviews and pipeline cleanup. About 20 applications in total, every one with a next action.

01 The math of a remote search

Why volume fails, what a realistic funnel looks like, and why the daily block is three hours and not eight.

Volume fails for two reasons. First, the pool. A remote listing is open to every eligible applicant on earth, so you are not competing with the people in your city; you are competing with the best-prepared applicant in every city. An untailored application, with no matching keywords, no human contact and no follow-up, is the median application in that pool.

Second, eligibility. Many remote postings are location-restricted: 'Remote (US)', 'must be based in the EU', 'we hire in these 12 countries', or a company with no legal entity and no employer-of-record arrangement where you live. Every application to one of those is a guaranteed zero that still costs 20 minutes and a slice of morale. The first job of a sprint is to stop paying that cost, which is why the daily loop below sources from the Remote Worldwide board first: location eligibility is checked before a posting is listed.

Here is a working funnel, stated as rules of thumb, not statistics. For well-targeted remote applications (eligible location, posting under a week old, tailored resume, one person on the team contacted), expect roughly 1 in 8 to reach a recruiter screen, 1 in 3 screens to reach a hiring-manager round, 1 in 2 hiring-manager rounds to reach a final, and 1 in 3 finals to become an offer. So 20 targeted applications gives you about 2 to 3 screens and about 1 hiring-manager round. A final round and a real shot at an offer usually take two sprints back to back, around 40 applications. 100 untargeted applications produces about the same number of screens for four times the hours and none of the follow-up.

Time the block to overlap with the working hours of the companies you target, so replies land while you are at your desk and you can answer within the hour. Lagos (UTC+1) applying to UK companies: 10:00 to 13:00 local. Nairobi (UTC+3) applying to UK companies: 11:00 to 14:00 local, or later. Manila (UTC+8) applying to US East Coast companies: 21:00 to midnight. A reply inside the hour is one of the few signals a remote hiring team can see before they meet you.

Why 3 hours, and what weekends are for

Fourteen days at 3 hours is 42 hours. Days 4 to 10 produce 3 quality applications a day, about 20 in total, each with a follow-up date attached. If you start on a Monday, Days 6, 7, 13 and 14 fall on weekends. Keep the block, change the work: submit applications (the ATS does not care what day it is), but hold every message to a human until Monday morning in their time zone, because a Saturday LinkedIn note reads as automated or desperate. Spend spare weekend minutes on the tailored resume for your second title, interview practice, or one piece of public work you can link to. Do not spend them on more applications.

02 Days 1-3: Foundation

Three days of setup. Skip them and Days 4 to 10 run at half speed.

1 Day 1: Pick two role titles, not five

Write down the two titles you will apply for. Two, because the same remote job appears under different names across companies (Customer Success Manager at one, Account Manager at another, Client Partner at a third) and you need to recognize it fast on a board that lists thousands. Keep the aliases next to your search. Apply for five titles and you will tailor nothing well.

2 Day 1: Build a watch list of 25 companies that can legally hire you

This list is your watch list, not your only source. For each company, answer one question first: do they hire where I live? Look for a 'where we hire' page, the location filter on their careers page, 'remote, anywhere' versus 'remote, US only', and whether they use an employer of record (Deel, Remote, Oyster, Rippling) or hire contractors globally. Two or more current employees in your country on LinkedIn is a strong sign, not a guarantee; they could be contractors or a since-closed arrangement, so confirm on the careers page. Know which kind of role you are looking at: contractor means you invoice monthly, handle your own tax, and get no paid leave or health cover; employee via an EOR means a local entity employs you with local benefits. Both are legitimate. Price yourself accordingly. Stop at 25 companies where the answer is yes.

3 Day 2: Build the master resume, then one tailored version

The master resume is a long private document: every role, every project, every number. Label remote work explicitly. 'Remote' in the location line is not enough; write 'fully remote team across 4 time zones (PT to CET)'. List the tools remote teams run on (Slack, Notion, Linear, Jira, Loom, Figma, GitHub) only where you really used them. Then cut a one- or two-page version for your top target title using a live posting's exact title and phrasing. Build the master at remoteworldwide.net/dashboard/resume and run the tailored version through the ATS scorer at remoteworldwide.net/dashboard/ats. Fix what it flags today so tomorrow's tailoring takes 25 minutes, not two hours.

4 Day 3: Fix LinkedIn and one portfolio link

Recruiters filter by location, and a profile whose location says only 'Remote' drops out of a search for 'Nigeria' or 'Philippines'. Set your real city and country, and put your time zone in the headline: 'Backend Engineer | UTC+1 | remote-first teams'. Turn on Open to Work with 'Remote' selected. Then fix one portfolio link: it opens in under two minutes, works without a login, and states your time zone and remote experience on the page itself. Add it to your Featured section. The Day 3 note you send next week links to it and is the first writing sample the hiring manager sees, so the link has to hold up.

5

Day 3: Load the tracker with the 25 companies

Enter all 25 at remoteworldwide.net/dashboard/tracker with the stage 'Researching'. Each morning of Days 4 to 10 you check their careers pages first; when one posts an eligible role, the row moves to 'Applied'. The rest of each day's postings come from the board. Day 4 is then execution, not another research day.

03 Days 4-10: The application engine

Seven days, the same loop each day. Three applications a day, each with a follow-up date.

1 Follow-ups first, always

Open the tracker and send everything due before you source a new posting. A reply from a company that has already seen you is worth more than five new applications, and recruiters answer during their morning, so a note sent at the start of your block can become a same-day call.

2 Source 3 postings under 7 days old

Check the careers pages of your 25 watch-list companies, then the Remote Worldwide board at remoteworldwide.net, where location eligibility is already checked. Filter for the last 7 days and prefer the last 72 hours; a listing up for 45 days is usually filled, on hold, or an evergreen post collecting resumes. On a thin day with fewer than 3 eligible postings, do not lower the bar. Put the spare tailoring block into the resume for your second title, a second human message on yesterday's applications, or the public work piece.

3 Run the eligibility check before you tailor

Location clause, time-zone requirement ('4 hours overlap with Pacific'), work authorization, employee or contractor. Two minutes here saves 25 minutes of tailoring for a job you cannot legally take.

4 Tailor for 25 minutes, no more

Start from the master. Match the posting's title and its top 5 to 8 skill terms exactly, move the most relevant bullets to the top of each role, and run the ATS scorer. The cap is the point: in a worldwide pool, three good applications with follow-up beat one perfect one without.

5 Write a three-sentence note

Even when the cover letter is optional: your time zone and its overlap with theirs, one thing about the company from the last 90 days, and a link to one piece of work. That is the whole letter.

6 Find one human

For every application, one short message to someone on the team: the hiring manager if named, otherwise someone in the role or one level up. Not only the recruiter. In remote companies the hiring manager often sees a direct message before the ATS queue reaches them.

Log it and set tomorrow's action

Company, role, date, stage 'Applied', next action 'Day-3 note to [name]', due in 3 days, or the following Monday if that lands on a weekend.

BLOCK	MINUTES	WHAT YOU DO
Follow-ups	20	Send every follow-up that is due, answer replies, update stages
Sourcing	30	Check watch-list careers pages, then the board; pick 3 postings under 7 days old and run the eligibility check on each
Tailoring	75	3 applications at 25 minutes each: resume, ATS score, three-sentence note, submit
Human outreach	30	One message per application, about 10 minutes each, to a real person on the team
Log and plan	15	Update the tracker, set next actions and due dates, write tomorrow's first task
Interview practice	10	One remote-specific question in a practice session at remoteworldwide.net/dashboard/prep

- ☐ The posting is under 7 days old, confirmed on the company's own careers page.
- ☐ The company hires in my country (board listing, careers page, or employer of record), and I know whether the role is employee or contractor.
- ☐ My time zone overlaps with their required hours, and the note says so in one line with the UTC offset.
- ☐ The resume uses the posting's exact title and at least 5 of its key terms, and I checked the ATS score.
- ☐ Remote experience is labeled explicitly (team spread, number of time zones, async tools), not implied.
- ☐ The note mentions one concrete thing about the company from the last 90 days: a launch, a handbook page, a changelog entry.
- ☐ There is one link to a piece of work that opens without a login and makes sense in under two minutes.
- ☐ I sent one message to a real person on the team, and the row is in the tracker with a next action and a due date.

04 Follow-up cadence

Most remote applications die from silence, not rejection. This schedule keeps you visible without becoming noise.

DAY	CHANNEL	MESSAGE PURPOSE
Day 0	Careers page + LinkedIn	Submit the application; connect with one team member with a two-line note
Day 3 (next Monday if a weekend)	LinkedIn message or email	Note to the hiring manager: time zone overlap, one piece of work, one real question
Day 7	Email to recruiter	Follow up and add one new thing you have done since applying
Day 14	Email	Close the loop: still interested, here is a one-page 30-day plan based on their public docs
Day 21	Tracker only	Move to Cold if no reply; set a 60-day reminder to check for a repost
Within 24h of any interview	Email, sent in their working hours	Thank-you that references one specific thing discussed and restates your availability

Three templates. Swap the brackets, keep the length. Each names a time zone, shows async work, and links to something concrete, because those are the three things a remote hiring manager cannot see from a resume.

Day 3, hiring manager, LinkedIn: "Hi [Name], I applied for the [Role] on [date]. I'm in Lagos (UTC+1), which gives me a full overlap with your UK team and mornings with US Eastern. Most of my last role ran async: I wrote the weekly product update that replaced our Monday status meeting, sample here [link]. One question: does this role sit with the [payments] team or the [platform] team? Either way, glad to be in the pipeline."

Day 7, recruiter, email, subject '[Role] application, [Your name], UTC+1': "Hi [Name], following up on my application from [date]. Since then I [shipped a small tool / published a write-up on X], link here [link]. Still very interested. The posting asks for 4 hours of Pacific overlap; from UTC+1 that is 17:00 to 21:00 my time, which suits me, and my last team was spread across 3 time zones, so async handoffs are normal for me. I can take a first call any weekday between 15:00 and 21:00 UTC. Thanks, [Name]."

Day 14, close the loop, email: "Hi [Name], last note from me on the [Role]. If it's filled, no reply needed. If it's open, here is a one-page note on what I would do in the first 30 days, written the

way I would post it in your team channel, based on your [public handbook / changelog / engineering blog]: [link]. I'm in [city, UTC offset], my last team ran on written updates across 3 time zones, and I could start remotely on [date]. Thank you either way."

05 Days 11-14: Interviews and pipeline hygiene

By Day 11 the first screens are landing. Four days to run them well and clean the pipeline for sprint two.

1 Day 11: Test the setup that is also the interview

For a remote role, the video call is part of the assessment. Test camera, microphone, lighting and a backup connection (a phone hotspot) before the first screen. Do a 5-minute recorded run in a practice session at remoteworldwide.net/dashboard/prep and watch it back. If your internet drops mid-call, you have shown them exactly what a bad remote day with you looks like.

2 Days 11-12: Prepare the five remote questions

Expect at least two of these in any remote interview: How do you work with people 8 hours ahead of you? Tell me about a time async communication failed and what you changed. How do you stay visible without a manager watching? What does your day look like with no fixed hours? Which tools have you used to run a project across time zones? Write a two-minute answer to each with a real example and a number in it, and run each one in a practice session.

3 Day 12: Confirm every interview time in both time zones

Reply to every invite with the time written twice: 'Tuesday 15:00 BST / 10:00 ET'. The US changes its clocks two to three weeks before the UK and EU in March and about a week after them in autumn, so an overlap that worked last month can shift by an hour. A missed call because of daylight saving is the most avoidable rejection there is.

4 Day 13 (Saturday): Audit the pipeline

Every row silent for 21 days moves to Cold with a 60-day reminder. Every Cold row, and every watch-list company that has posted nothing eligible in two weeks, gets replaced with a fresh company from the board, so the pipeline stays at 25 live rows. Give every remaining row a next action and a date. No messages go out today; queue them for Monday.

5 Day 14 (Sunday): Run the numbers and plan sprint two

Count applications sent, replies received, screens booked. Fewer than 1 reply in 10 usually means a targeting problem: check location eligibility and posting age before touching the resume. Screens that never become second rounds point to interview prep. Write the two changes you will make. Sprint two starts tomorrow, Monday, and its setup days are shorter: refresh the watch list, do not rebuild it.

Rejections and ghosting

Ghosting is the normal end state of a remote application. A single recruiter often runs many requisitions at once, each open to a worldwide pool, and only the shortlist hears back. That is what the Day 21 rule is for: silence moves a row to Cold, it does not delete it, because remote companies re-post roles when a hire falls through at the visa or contract stage. When you get a written rejection, reply within a day, two lines: thank them, and ask to be kept in mind for the same team. That reply is the name they remember when the repost goes up.

06 The pipeline tracker

An application with no next action is already dying. Here is what a live pipeline looks like on 9 September.

COMPANY	ROLE	APPLIED	STAGE	NEXT ACTION	DUE
Northwind Labs	Customer Success Manager (EMEA)	8 Sep	Applied	Day-3 note to hiring manager, Priya M., with time zone overlap and Loom link	11 Sep
Ferrous Analytics	Backend Engineer (EU hours)	5 Sep	Screen booked	Confirm time in CEST and WAT; test camera and hotspot	9 Sep
Kestrel Health	Product Designer	1 Sep	Day-7 follow-up sent	Day-14 close-the-loop with one-page 30-day note	15 Sep
Bright Ledger	Support Specialist (US, contractor)	12 Aug	Cold	Re-check careers page for a repost	12 Oct

Company – Role – Stage –
Next action

Company – Role – Stage –
Next action

Company – Role – Stage –
Next action

Company – Role – Stage –
Next action

Company – Role – Stage –
Next action

Company – Role – Stage –
Next action

Keep the pipeline moving

Paper works for one sprint. For the second one, use the free application tracker: it holds every company, stage and next action, lets you set a follow-up reminder on each application so the Day 3, 7 and 14 messages go out on time, and keeps a daily streak so the 3-hour block becomes a habit instead of a plan.

[Track my applications →](#)